

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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Dear Mission Execution team,

I am applying for Mission Manager on the Mission Execution team in Alameda. I live in Emeryville aboard MARGARITA, a 1966 sailboat. For three years I have turned stakeholder objectives into executable plans, written the SOPs and training that let other people run them, and stayed through delivery.

Saildrone has 12+ years of ocean operations and a global Explorer, Voyager, and Surveyor fleet, with Mission Execution in Alameda. The Mission Manager sits between customers, Fleet Captains, engineering, and Product: turn routing and CONOPS into a plan the fleet can run, keep execution aligned, and feed vehicle performance and health back into SOPs and the product roadmap. That is the work I want to do.

How I would cover the work:

- **Executable mission plans:** I run discovery with operators, map the present-day workflow, and write the plan, specs, and delivery gates the team runs. Closest analog to a feasibility pass with Sales: I owned an MSP pre-sales risk-assessment workflow, then trained their team to run it.
- **SOPs, documentation, and training:** I automated that MSP pre-sales workflow, cut processing time 98%, then trained the team to run and extend it. I also delivered EZ-AI, problem-first training for domain experts. I would use the same muscle to refine Mission Control SOPs and customer training, not to invent a parallel process set.
- **Status, systems, and product feedback:** At IBM I shipped C-level operational dashboards (Tableau, Cognos) and the release notes for each change. In consulting I kept a living backlog and modernized a data-ingestion pipeline (throughput +99.8% in four months, cost fell 86%). I would send vehicle health the same way: precise status up, structured feedback to Product and R&D.
- **Pressure:** EMT (2024). Patient assessment and radio/team communication while the situation is still moving. Judgment under uncertainty, not a 24/7 Mission Control watch.

One real gap, named plainly: I do not have professional COLREGS, VTS, or Coast Guard liaison tenure, and I have not piloted USVs or sat a 24/7 ops-center watch. I bring complex technical operations, process documentation, operational tooling in Python, and a life already on the Bay. COLREGS, port reporting, and watch discipline are what I would close first on the job.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about turning a Mission Portal routing request into a plan Fleet Captains can run.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker